

button near the Edit Signature tab. A new box will appear saying 'Advanced Signature Settings' where you can select the account with which the signature should be automatically added.

Customise the mailbox

You can change the feel and look of your mailbox, and personalise it with the fonts of your choice, along with a view that you like.

To change the default font for all your outgoing messages from Arial to something better, go to **Tools > Options > Compose > Font Settings** and specify the font and font size for all new messages.

To change the default layout go to **View > Layout**. Here you can change the way messages are viewed and remove other components such as the toolbar, status bar, folder bar, etc. This will give a neater look to your Outlook Express.

Customise your toolbar

The Outlook Express toolbar is cluttered with many not-so-useful icons. Right-click on the toolbar and customise it by adding or removing the icons; you can also reduce the size of icons and remove the text labels.

Disable MSN Messenger from auto-starting

Whenever one opens



Disable MSN startup in Microsoft Outlook

Outlook Express or Microsoft Outlook XP, MSN Messenger loads automatically. To disable it, go to **Tools > Options** in Outlook Express and uncheck 'Automatically log on to MSN

Messenger Service'. Then go to **View > Layout** and uncheck the option of Contacts. In Microsoft Outlook XP, go to **Tools > Options > Other** and uncheck 'Enable MSN Messenger'. The over-eager Messenger won't be so eager now!

Keep a copy of the message

If you are on a trip and want to access your e-mail from another machine, keep a copy of your messages on the server of your e-mail service provider.

Go to **Tools > Accounts** and select the account (if you have multiple accounts), then go to **Properties > Advanced**. Check 'Leave a copy on server'.

This has one more advantage: if you've formatted your machine without taking a backup of your mail, you can retrieve the mail as a stored copy.

Autocomplete e-mail addresses

Enable the AutoComplete feature in Outlook Express to automatically finish the e-mail addresses after you type the first letter in the 'To' column. Go to **Tools > Options > Send** and check the option, 'Automatically complete e-mail addresses while composing'. This will make it less tedious and save a lot of time.

Auto-respond facility

Won't be checking mail for



A three-step process to ensure that your Inbox never looks cluttered.

1. Organising: Outlook Express allows you to create folders within which mail can be organised. To create a new folder in Outlook Express, go to **File > Folder > New**. This will display the directory tree of your Inbox. Just select the location (say Inbox) where you want to create a folder and enter the Folder Name. Or, you could use the shortcut [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [E] and enter the Folder Name. You can also drag and drop folders to change their location. Folders can be quite useful, especially if you have multiple accounts configured on the same identity or to sort out e-mail messages on

Optimising your Inbox

the basis of sender, subject, etc. 2. Filtering: Message Rules can automatically sort your mail into the appropriate folder as soon as it is downloaded. Specify the folders where you want the messages to be downloaded based on names in the From address, names in the To address, certain words in the Subject line or in the message body.

Go to **Message > Create Rule From Message**. Create a rule selecting the appropriate options offered, and the next time you download your mail, it will be sorted according to the rules created.

You can also sort your existing messages based on the message rules created. In Outlook Express, go to **Tools > Message Rules** and click on Mail. You will

get a list of the message rules you have created. Click on 'Apply Now...', select the rules to apply, and click on Apply to filter your existing folder. 3. Grouping: Outlook Express allows you to group e-mail messages on the basis of the conversation carried. To enable this, go to **View > Current View** and click 'Group Messages by Conversation' (In Outlook, this option is available from **View > Current View > Conversation Topic**).

With this feature, all e-mail messages are sorted on the basis of the subject line and the messages that are a reply to that particular subject are grouped together. A '+' sign next to a message indicates responses based on that subject.



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